

cherished people coming to him. If your boss would not want you to ask, it may be a sign it's time to find a new boss.

One thing you can do to increase your value is furthering your education. This builds on previous ideas of hacking college, becoming a lifelong learner, and incrementally making progress by obtaining skills that complement one another. ESI started with a salary of \$40,000, earned an MBA paid for by his employer, and doubled his salary in only two years. If you rely on the 3 percent raise, you can double your salary as well . . . in 24 years! Many people in the FI community have used similar strategies. They utilize employer programs to get advanced degrees and training for free or at minimal cost, which they then leverage into higher pay.

I witnessed this in my own home when my wife earned an MBA and a Master's of Operations Research, both of which were paid for by a former employer while she paid only for books. Earlier in this book, we discussed the talent stack as a way of creating unique value. We live in a world where people frequently have a hard time finding a job. Those who do often complain of greedy corporations that only care about profit. My wife's technical skills and business acumen allowed her to obtain a job she loves with working conditions so good she changed her mind on the "retire early" part of FIRE. How